

D726

Early Clinical in Secondary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A ninth-grade biology class loses about seven minutes at the start of each period while students chat and the teacher takes attendance. The room has lab stations and a new smart board, and the school mascot is painted on the wall. Which change best protects that time?

- A. Use the smart board to show a countdown with no task.
- B. Post a short do-now task students start on entry while attendance is taken.
- C. Accept it, since the first minutes are always lost in high school.
- D. Take attendance faster by calling names louder.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

While reviewing a history lesson on the causes of a war, a candidate lists questions the teacher asked. The teacher used a slideshow with twenty images and a map from a museum website. Which question demands the highest level of thinking?

- A. "Which cause do you think mattered most, and what evidence supports your choice?"
- B. "What were the three causes listed on the slide?"
- C. "Where is the map image from?"
- D. "In what year did the war begin?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a quick check that students can remember the definitions from yesterday before moving on. Which question type fits the purpose?

- A. A create question asking students to design a new term.
- B. A recall question, such as "What does the term mean?"
- C. An evaluation question asking which definition is best.
- D. Any question, because level never matters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An eleventh-grade English class is writing persuasive essays. Many students say, “Why do we have to write about this?” The class has 31 students, and the room was moved to the new wing. Which plan best addresses the pattern?

- A. Give detentions to students who complain.
- B. Split the class of 31 into two rooms.
- C. Let students write about anything with no guidelines at all.
- D. Let students choose from topics tied to issues in their lives and explain how persuasion is used outside school.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a tenth-grade history class, students read a 1920s newspaper article about a strike and simply summarize it. The article is two pages long, and the class uses laptops bought with a grant. Which next step builds disciplinary literacy?

- A. Let students search their laptops for a shorter article.
- B. Use a general strategy like predicting the ending.
- C. Have students summarize it again in fewer words.
- D. Teach students to ask who wrote it, when, why, and to compare it with another source.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A chemistry teacher wants students to read a lab report like scientists. Which question should students learn to ask first?

- A. “Do the methods and data support the claim?”
- B. “When was the newspaper printed?”
- C. “What is the main idea in one sentence?”
- D. “Who is the author’s favorite scientist?”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

During a geometry lecture, a student quietly taps a pencil and looks at his phone under the desk. The rest of the class is taking notes, and the lesson is about the Pythagorean theorem, which the district tests in May. What is the best first response?

- A. Walk near the student while teaching and give a quiet nonverbal cue.
- B. Remind the class the theorem is on the May test.
- C. Write an office referral immediately.
- D. Stop the lesson and call out the student by name.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher has already used proximity and a quiet cue, but a student keeps using a phone during notes. What is the next step in the least-intrusive sequence?

- A. Call a parent in front of the class.
- B. Go back to proximity again and keep waiting.
- C. A brief private reminder of the expectation and a choice, such as putting the phone away or in the class bin.
- D. Confiscate every phone in the class.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

In a twelfth-grade economics class, the teacher asks, “What happens to price when supply falls?” and the same four volunteers answer every time. The room has a stock ticker display, and the class meets right after lunch. Which change gives the teacher the best picture of the whole class?

- A. Move the class to a morning period.
- B. Keep calling on volunteers, since they know the answer.
- C. Have every student write an answer on a whiteboard or card and show it at once.
- D. Call on students whose hands are down, only once a week.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate's draft objective for a ninth-grade science lab reads: "Students will understand density." The lab uses graduated cylinders and small metal cubes the school received from a local company. Which revision is measurable?

- A. "Students will know everything about density."
- B. "Students will really understand density."
- C. "Students will appreciate the company's donation."
- D. "Students will calculate the density of three objects from measured mass and volume."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An objective says, "Students will compare two poems' use of imagery in a paragraph." What evidence would show students met it?

- A. A paragraph about one poem only.
- B. Students saying they liked the poems.
- C. A paragraph that compares imagery in both poems.
- D. A quiz on the poets' birth dates.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

After an observation, a mentor tells a candidate that directions were unclear, pacing was slow, and he rarely checked for understanding. The mentor has twenty years of experience, and the class was a small group of 14. What is the best way to integrate this feedback?

- A. Wait for a larger class before trying anything new.
- B. Pick one change, such as checking understanding after directions, try it in the next lesson, and gather evidence.
- C. Explain to the mentor why the pacing was right.
- D. Change all three things at once in the next lesson.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A ninth-grade biology class loses about seven minutes at the start of each period while students chat and the teacher takes attendance. ~~The room has lab stations and a new smart board, and the school mascot is painted on the wall.~~ Which change best protects that time?

Target word: recover lost start time **Decides:** The first minutes have no student task.

A	Camouflage	Answers the board detail; a timer without work does not recover learning time.
B	Correct	A routine entry task makes the opening minutes instructional.
C	Absolute language	Planned routines reliably reclaim this time.
D	Dropped element	Still leaves students with nothing to do.

2. Answer A Concept 2

While reviewing a history lesson on the causes of a war, a candidate lists questions the teacher asked. The teacher used a slideshow ~~with twenty images and a map from a museum website.~~ Which question demands the highest level of thinking?

Target word: highest-level question **Decides:** Evaluate/judge with reasons is higher than recall or explain.

A	Correct	It asks students to evaluate and defend a judgment.
B	Confusion set	Recall of listed facts, even though the topic is causes.
C	Camouflage	Answers the source-of-image detail, not the lesson thinking.
D	Inverted operation	Pure recall.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

A teacher wants a quick check that students can remember the definitions from yesterday before moving on. Which question type fits the purpose?

Target word: reverse: pick the level for a purpose **Decides:** The goal is recall.

A	Adjacent category	Higher level than needed for this purpose.
B	Correct	Checking memory calls for a recall-level question.
C	Inverted operation	Asks for judgment, not memory check.
D	Absolute language	The level should match the purpose.

4. Answer D Concept 3

An eleventh-grade English class is writing persuasive essays. Many students say, “Why do we have to write about this?” ~~The class has 31 students, and the room was moved to the new wing.~~ Which plan best addresses the pattern?

Target word: response to teen disengagement **Decides:** Teens need relevance and structured choice.

A	Adjacent category	Treats a motivation need as only discipline.
B	Camouflage	Answers the class-size detail, which does not address relevance.
C	Absolute language	Choice should be structured to still meet the standard.
D	Correct	Choice and visible purpose raise adolescent engagement.

5. Answer D Concept 4

In a tenth-grade history class, students read a 1920s newspaper article about a strike and simply summarize it. ~~The article is two pages long, and the class uses laptops bought with a grant.~~ Which next step builds disciplinary literacy?

Target word: subject-specific reading move **Decides:** Historians source a document before trusting it.

A	Camouflage	Answers the length and laptop details; avoids the reading skill.
B	Adjacent category	A generic strategy, not how historians read.
C	Dropped element	Summary alone skips the disciplinary move.
D	Correct	Sourcing and corroboration are core history reading moves.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A chemistry teacher wants students to read a lab report like scientists. Which question should students learn to ask first?

Target word: reverse: apply the move to science **Decides:** Scientists judge claims by method and data.

A	Correct	Science reading evaluates evidence and procedure.
B	Confusion set	A history sourcing move applied to the wrong discipline.
C	Adjacent category	General comprehension, not the science-specific move.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail, not evidence.

7. Answer A Concept 5

During a geometry lecture, a student quietly taps a pencil and looks at his phone under the desk. The rest of the class is taking notes, and the lesson is about the Pythagorean theorem, ~~which the district tests in May.~~ What is the best first response?

Target word: first response to minor behavior **Decides:** A minor, quiet behavior during instruction.

A	Correct	Least intrusive moves keep the lesson going and preserve dignity.
B	Camouflage	Answers the test detail, not the behavior.
C	Adjacent category	Removal is for serious or repeated behavior after lower steps.
D	Inverted operation	Escalates first and disrupts everyone.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher has already used proximity and a quiet cue, but a student keeps using a phone during notes. What is the next step in the least-intrusive sequence?

Target word: next rung after lower steps fail **Decides:** Escalate one step, privately.

A	Dropped element	Skips the private reminder and embarrasses the student.
B	Inverted operation	Repeats a step that already failed.
C	Correct	Move up one level while staying private and calm.
D	Absolute language	Punishes the whole group for one student's behavior.

9. Answer C Concept 6

In a twelfth-grade economics class, the teacher asks, “What happens to price when supply falls?” and the same four volunteers answer every time. ~~The room has a stock ticker display, and the class meets right after lunch.~~ Which change gives the teacher the best picture of the whole class?

Target word: broaden participation **Decides:** Only volunteers answer.

A	Camouflage	Answers the schedule detail, not the method.
B	Inverted operation	Samples only students who already know.
C	Correct	All-response methods show each student’s thinking.
D	Dropped element	Too rare to show what the class knows.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A candidate’s draft objective for a ninth-grade science lab reads: “Students will understand density.” The lab uses graduated cylinders and small metal cubes ~~the school received from a local company.~~ Which revision is measurable?

Target word: measurable objective **Decides:** Needs an observable action.

A	Absolute language	“Know” is not observable and “everything” cannot be checked.
B	Dropped element	Adds emphasis but keeps an unobservable verb.
C	Camouflage	Answers the donation detail and is not measurable.
D	Correct	“Calculate” is observable and checkable.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

An objective says, “Students will compare two poems’ use of imagery in a paragraph.” What evidence would show students met it?

Target word: reverse: from objective to evidence **Decides:** The observable product named in the objective.

A	Dropped element	Drops the second poem that the comparison requires.
B	Adjacent category	Opinion, not the comparison named.
C	Correct	The objective’s verb and product define the evidence.
D	Confusion set	Measures recall of unrelated facts.

12. Answer B Concept 8

After an observation, a mentor tells a candidate that directions were unclear, pacing was slow, and he rarely checked for understanding. ~~The mentor has twenty years of experience, and the class was a small group of 14.~~ What is the best way to integrate this feedback?

Target word: act on feedback **Decides:** Several points; pick one high-leverage change and test it.

A	Camouflage	Answers the class-size detail; delays growth.
B	Correct	Focused change with evidence is how feedback turns into growth.
C	Inverted operation	Defends practice instead of acting on feedback.
D	Absolute language	Trying to fix everything at once makes it hard to see what worked.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	9	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Bell-to-bell routines	A posted task students start on entry (a do-now) and planned transitions protect instructional time from the first minute to the last.	Assuming lost minutes at the start and end of class are unavoidable.	Class time lost at the start, end, or between activities.
2	Question levels	Recall questions check facts; higher-order questions ask students to analyze, evaluate, or create, and lead to deeper thinking.	Believing a question is higher-order because it is long or about a hard topic.	Sort a question by the thinking it demands, not its topic.
3	Adolescent need for autonomy and relevance	Teens engage more when they have structured choices and can see why the work matters to their lives or goals.	Treating disengagement only as a discipline problem to punish.	Older students ask “Why do we need this?” or disengage from tasks with no choice.
4	Disciplinary literacy	Each subject reads and writes in its own way — historians source and corroborate documents, scientists weigh data and methods — and those moves must be taught.	Thinking general reading strategies alone are enough in every subject.	Students summarize a source without asking who wrote it or how the claim was tested.
5	Least intrusive intervention first	Handle minor misbehavior with the least disruptive move (proximity, a look, a quiet cue) before escalating to public correction or removal.	Starting with a referral or public call-out for a minor behavior.	A small, brief behavior during instruction.
6	Equitable participation	Structures such as think-pair-share, response cards, and random calling get every student thinking, not just volunteers.	Believing hands-up questioning shows what the whole class knows.	The same few students answer every question.
7	Measurable learning objectives	A strong objective names an observable student action (such as compare, solve, write) tied to the content, so it can be checked.	Using verbs like “understand,” “know,” or “appreciate” that cannot be seen.	Choosing or fixing a lesson objective.
8	Integrating mentor feedback	Turn feedback into one specific, high-leverage change, try it, and collect evidence on whether it worked.	Trying to fix everything at once, or defending the old approach.	A candidate gets several pieces of feedback after an observation.

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.